

Data Day 2027 — Theme Concept (DRAFT)

Status: — headline “*Five Years Forward*”, subhead “*Shaping what’s next for Central Ohio’s data community.*” Direction: anniversary-based, mostly forward-looking (no topical theme, so every session fits). Visual identity still to finalize. Voice: outward MORPC/RDR — mission-forward and inviting.

Theme: Five Years Forward

Data Day 2027 · Shaping what’s next for Central Ohio’s data community

The idea in one line: the fifth anniversary isn’t a scrapbook — it’s a launch pad. We’ve spent five years convening the region’s data community; now the question is where we take it next.

The narrative. Over five years, Data Day has brought Central Ohio’s local governments, nonprofits, educational institutions, and civic-minded businesses together around a shared belief — that better use of data improves the region. Five years in, that community is real, and *Five Years Forward* turns the milestone into momentum: honoring how far the region has come, then pointing the whole room at what’s ahead.

How it threads through the program

- **Program.** Frame the keynotes as *where the field is heading* — a forward-looking opener and a “what’s next” lunch keynote. Individual sessions need not obey the theme; the Regional Data Agenda reflection prompt already carries the mission thread.
- **Champions.** Near-perfect fit — the Champions model *is* the forward-looking evolution (replacing the old monthly Working Group). “The community that carries us forward.”
- **Marketing / comms.** Momentum language — countdown, “5 years in motion,” then-and-now stats (growth from the first Data Day to 2027). An energetic hook for the biggest-growth year.
- **Sponsorship.** Reframes the ask as *investing in the next five years*, not underwriting a single event.
- **Visual motif.** Motion — arrows, a forward-leaning “5,” a path/road, momentum lines. A clear, modern brief for designers.

Subhead: selected

Subhead: “Shaping what’s next for Central Ohio’s data community.” Names the community, points ahead, and pairs with “Forward” without doubling the metaphor.

Guardrail for all derived copy: keep the tone forward-looking. Avoid sliding into “celebrating five years of building community” — that reverts to the stale, backward-looking voice this concept is meant to avoid.

Open items / to verify

- **Then-and-now stats:** gather attendance/session counts across the five years for the momentum narrative (no need to pin an exact founding year — keep references to “five years” / “the first Data Day”).
- **Design brief:** translate the motion motif into the visual identity once wording is final.